Fuel
WITH JESS



FREE GUIDE

Counting Macros
Starter Guide

Find your starting numbers in about 15 minutes, without cutting out the foods you love.

Life is short. Eat more carbs. Do hard things.

JESS PIERCE
NASM-CERTIFIED NUTRITION COACH



WELCOME

Hi, I'm *Jess*

Life is short. Eat more carbs. Do hard things. This guide gives you your own starting macro targets, so your nutrition finally matches the effort you're already putting in.

I'm a NASM-certified nutrition coach and the founder of Fuel with Jess. I spent 20 years leading teams in corporate retail, and I bring that same structure and follow-through to helping active people lose fat and build muscle.

Nutrition didn't just change my body, it changed my life. It helped me lose fat, build muscle, heal a chronic disease and calm my nervous system. I'm a different person today, and I'm passionate about helping you live longer and happier too.

No foods are off-limits here. Just a clear system you can actually stick with.

Jess

INSIDE THIS GUIDE

1 What macros are and why they matter more than calories alone

2 A simple worksheet to calculate your starting numbers

3 Go-to food lists for protein, carbs and fat

4 How to track without losing your mind

5 A build-a-plate formula and a sample day

6 The most common mistakes, and how to skip them

PART 1

Macros *101*

Macros are the three nutrients that supply all your calories. Hitting a target for each shapes *what* your weight change is made of: muscle or fat.

4 CAL / G

Protein

Builds and repairs muscle, keeps you full.

Every meal, especially after training

4 CAL / G

Carbohydrates

Primary fuel for training and your brain.

Around workouts and on active days

9 CAL / G

Fat

Hormones, joint health, vitamin absorption.

Spread through the day, lighter pre-workout

Why not just count calories? Calories decide whether the scale goes up or down. Macros decide whether that change comes from fat or muscle, and that's where the lean, strong look comes from. Hitting your macros automatically covers your calories, but a calorie number alone tells you nothing about your macros.

Same calories, different results

Both days land at 1,800 calories and a calorie deficit. Only one protects your muscle.

	LOW-PROTEIN DAY	MACRO-BUILT DAY
Protein	50 g (200 cal)	135 g (540 cal)
Carbs	256 g (1,024 cal)	198 g (792 cal)
Fat	64 g (576 cal)	52 g (468 cal)
Total	**1,800 cal**	**1,800 cal**
What you lose	Fat *and* muscle	Mostly fat

What about micronutrients? Vitamins and minerals keep you healthy, but they have no calories, so they don't count toward your macros. Cover them by eating a variety of fruits and vegetables.

PART 2

Find your *starting numbers*

Five steps and a calculator. Treat it as a first draft: track for 2–3 weeks, then adjust based on how your body responds.

1. **Estimate maintenance calories.** Multiply your body weight (lb) by your activity number:
   - Mostly sitting, little exercise: 12–13
   - Lightly active, 2–3 workouts a week: 14
   - Active, 4–5 workouts a week: 15
   - Very active, daily hard training or a physical job: 16–17
2. **Adjust for your goal.** Lose fat: × 0.80–0.85. Maintain: keep it. Build muscle: × 1.05–1.10.
3. **Set protein.** 0.8–1.0 g per pound of goal body weight. Multiply grams by 4 for calories.
4. **Set fat.** 0.3–0.4 g per pound of goal body weight. Multiply grams by 9 for calories.
5. **Fill the rest with carbs.** Subtract protein and fat calories from your total, then divide by 4.

Example: 160 lb, trains 5 days a week, wants to lose fat

STEP	MATH	RESULT
Maintenance	160 × 15	2,400 cal
Goal calories	2,400 × 0.85	2,040 cal
Protein	160 × 0.9 = 144 g × 4	576 cal
Fat	160 × 0.35 = 56 g × 9	504 cal
Carbs	(2,040 − 576 − 504) ÷ 4	240 g

144 g PROTEIN

240 g CARBS

56 g FAT

Yes, that's a lot of carbs. That's the point.

YOUR TURN

Your macro *worksheet*

Grab a pen and a calculator. Fill in each line using the steps on the previous page.

STEP	YOUR MATH	YOUR RESULT
Maintenance calories	_____ lb × _____	_____ cal
Goal calories	_____ × _____	_____ cal
Protein	_____ lb × _____ g	_____ g
Fat	_____ lb × _____ g	_____ g
Carbs	(_____ − _____ − _____) ÷ 4	_____ g

My daily targets

PROTEIN (G)	CARBS (G)	FAT (G)

Not sure your numbers are right? An Advanced Macro Assessment ($75) gets your targets reviewed and adjusted by me.

PART 3

Your go-to *food lists*

Build most meals from these and hitting your numbers gets easy. Macros are approximate per listed portion.

Protein

FOOD	PORTION	G
Chicken breast, cooked	4 oz	35
Canned tuna, drained	1 can (5 oz)	25
97% lean ground beef, cooked	4 oz	28
Ground turkey 93/7, cooked	4 oz	28
Salmon, cooked	4 oz	25
Nonfat Greek yogurt	1 cup	23
Egg whites	1 cup	26
Whey protein	1 scoop	24
Cottage cheese, low-fat	1 cup	28
Extra-firm tofu	4 oz	12

Carbs

FOOD	PORTION	G
Potato, white	1 medium	37
Apple	1 medium	25
Jasmine rice, cooked	1 cup	45
Oats, dry	½ cup	27
Sweet potato	1 medium	26
Banana	1 medium	27
Sourdough bread	1 slice	18
Pasta, cooked	1 cup	43
Berries	1 cup	15–20
Chickpeas, cooked	½ cup	22

Fats

FOOD	PORTION	G
Olive oil	1 tbsp	14
Avocado	½ medium	11
Chia seeds	2 tbsp	8
Almonds	1 oz (~23)	14
Whole egg	1 large	5
Cheddar cheese	1 oz	9

PART 4

How to track *(without losing your mind)*

You don't need to be perfect. Landing within about 5–10 g of each target most days is a win.

Use an app.

I recommend MyFitnessPal. Scan barcodes and save meals you repeat.

Let the app do the math.

Weigh the food, enter that weight, and the app works out the protein, carbs and fat for you.

Log before you eat.

Planning the day in the morning beats guessing at night.

Repeat breakfasts and lunches.

Fewer decisions, easier logging, more room for flexible dinners.

Weigh, don't eyeball, at first.

A $15 food scale is the best tool you'll buy. Weigh in grams for 2–3 weeks to train your eye.

Keep meals simple.

A 12-ingredient casserole is a pain to log. Chicken, rice and roasted veggies takes 30 seconds.

Count the sneaky stuff.

Cooking oil, sauces, creamer and bites off your kid's plate add up fast.

Check trends, not single days.

Look at your weekly average weight and how training feels before changing numbers.

PART 5

Build *your plate*

Every meal starts with protein, then carbs to fuel your training, then color, then a little fat.

1 · Protein first
1–2 palm-sized portions (25–50 g)

2 · Carbs
1–2 cupped handfuls; go bigger around workouts

3 · Veggies or fruit
Fill the rest of the plate

4 · Fat
1–2 thumb-sized portions, oil and sauces included

A sample day

Built to land close to the example targets: 144 g protein · 240 g carbs · 56 g fat.

MEAL	WHAT'S ON THE PLATE	P	C	F
Breakfast	1 cup Greek yogurt, ½ cup oats, 1 banana, 2 tbsp chia seeds	33	73	11
Lunch	5 oz chicken, 1½ cups jasmine rice, veggies, ½ avocado	54	85	17
Pre-workout	Whey shake, 1 cup berries, 1 slice sourdough with 1 tsp honey	29	45	2
Dinner	4 oz salmon, sweet potato, veggies roasted in 1 tbsp olive oil	29	36	23
Total (g)		**145**	**239**	**53**

Real meals from my kitchen



Shrimp spring rolls with dipping sauce



Egg scramble with spinach, tomato and feta, plus sourdough and avocado



Shredded chicken breast, green grapes, Greek yogurt and hot honey mustard bowl

PART 6

Common mistakes *& quick answers*

The #1 beginner mistake: confusing food weight with protein grams. A 150 g serving of Greek yogurt has about 15 g of protein, not 150. Log the food's weight and let the app calculate the macros.

- **Cutting carbs to lose faster.** Your training suffers, you lose muscle, and the weight comes back.
- **Under-eating protein.** It's the macro most people miss, and the one that protects your muscle.
- **Changing numbers after three days.** Give any target 2–3 weeks before you adjust.
- **All-or-nothing weekends.** One off-plan meal is fine. Logging it anyway keeps you honest and on track.
- **Eating back every workout.** Your activity number already accounts for your training.

FAQs

Do I have to hit my numbers exactly?

No. Aim for protein within 10 g and total calories within about 100.

What about alcohol?

It has 7 calories per gram. Count drinks toward your carbs or fat for the day.

Can I eat dessert?

Yes. Fit it in and keep going. That's the whole point of flexible tracking.

When should I change my macros?

If your weekly average weight hasn't moved in 2–3 weeks, adjust calories by 5–10%, mostly from carbs or fat.

Do I have to count macros forever?

No. Tracking is a learning tool that teaches portions and balance. Most clients track closely at first, then shift to a more intuitive approach once the habits stick.

Do you offer virtual coaching?

Yes. I coach clients virtually anywhere, and in person in San Diego. Virtual clients get the same plans, check-ins and support as local clients.

What's the difference between a nutrition coach and a registered dietitian?

A registered dietitian is a licensed clinician who can provide medical nutrition therapy for diagnosed conditions. As a certified nutrition coach, I focus on performance, body composition and healthy habits for generally healthy adults, and I refer clients to a dietitian or doctor when medical care is needed.

NEXT STEP

Ready for numbers *built just for you?*

This guide gets you started. Coaching gets you results faster, with targets adjusted to your training, your schedule and how your body actually responds.



PLAN	WHAT YOU GET	MONTHLY
Self-Guided Roadmap + foundation	Custom macro targets and a bi-weekly review	$149
Core Weekly accountability	Weekly check-ins, lifestyle tracking and guidance, coach messaging	$249
VIP MOST POPULAR Hands-on coaching	Priority messaging, food tracking guidance, meal planning, body composition review, in-person options	$349

Save 15% with a 3-month commitment, then continue month to month.

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> *"Jess makes healthy eating feel manageable, not restrictive or intimidating."*
>
> BECCA · TEACHER · VIP CLIENT

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